

Art & Design

Year 6

Cambridge Primary
Student Manual



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The Loft Studio

A Cambridge Primary student book for Upper Primary.
Written for pupils of about ten to eleven years old who are ready to combine print methods, draw with humour and perspective, paint from real encounters, and sculpt in wire.

Four tables in one loft studio: print, drawing, paint and wire.
Rufus the fox and Bruno the bear work beside you.

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Editorial Board

The Prime Books Subject Series has been developed under the guidance of the Pedagogical Academic Group for each subject and coordinated by the Pedagogical Team of Prime School.

This publication reflects our shared commitment to academic excellence, educational quality, professional integrity, and the continuous advancement of teaching and learning. Through the collective expertise and dedication of our educators, we aim to provide meaningful and engaging learning resources that support students' academic growth.

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Interior 8.5 × 11 in (Amazon KDP). British English throughout.

This book is meant to be used. Print in it. Draw in it. Paint and sculpt in it.

Safety: washable media, blunt tools, print inks with adult rules, wire ends taped or capped, cutting tools only with school policy. Teachers follow school safety guidance.

Contents

Welcome to the Loft Studio	04
Who you will meet	06
How to use this book	07
Getting set up	09
Unit 1 Combining printing approaches	11
1.1 Reviewing printing techniques	13
1.2 Combining print methods	17
1.3 Colour, texture and pattern	21
1.4 Final print project	25
Unit 2 Drawing humour and perspective	30
2.1 One- and two-point perspective	32
2.2 Exaggerated proportions and humour	36
2.3 Dynamic and expressive drawings	40
2.4 Depth and space with perspective	43
Unit 3 Painting creatively from encounters	47
3.1 Observing and interpreting	49
3.2 Colour, texture and brush techniques	52

3.3 A personal painting from observation	56
3.4 Visual storytelling	59
Unit 4 Sculpting with wire	64
4.1 Wire as a sculptural material	66
4.2 Texture and effects in wire	70
4.3 Wire with other materials	73
4.4 Building three-dimensional forms	76
Studio show	81
Answers	83
Studio words	86
Sources and references	87
For teachers	88
Studio sketchbook	89
My studio notes	96

Welcome to the Loft Studio

There is a tall window, an easel with a half-finished painting, a jar of brushes and a coil of soft wire on a wooden table.

This book is that room. It is called **the Loft Studio**, and it belongs to you for Year 6.

In earlier years you printed simple blocks, drew with care, painted with purpose and built standing forms. Keep that. This year your hands learn four deeper crafts: **combining printing approaches**, **drawing with humour and perspective**, **painting creatively from encounters**, and **sculpting with wire**.

🔗 DO YOU REMEMBER?

Year 5 asked for control and choice. Year 6 asks for independence: combine methods, invent visual humour, paint what you really met, and build wire forms that stand in space.

Four tables, one room

The loft has four working tables, and each one is a unit of this book.

TABLE	UNIT	WHAT YOUR HANDS LEARN
Print table	1	to combine methods, and to decide the order of layers
Drawing table	2	to build depth with rules, and character with exaggeration
Paint table	3	to work from something real, and to choose what to emphasise
Wire table	4	to turn a line into a form that stands and has a back

You will finish one piece at each table. At the end of the book those four pieces become your **studio show**, so keep everything, including the tests that did not work. A printer's failed pull is evidence of thinking, and it is worth showing.

What independence looks like this year

Nobody will tell you which method to use for the final print, which feature to exaggerate, or what your painting should be about. You will be asked to decide, to write down what you decided, and to say why. That last part is the Year 6 skill: not only making something good, but knowing what made it good so you can do it again.

Who you will meet



Rufus the fox

He layers prints until the colours talk. He finds vanishing points without rushing. He plans a wire armature before the first bend.



Bruno the bear

He paints what he really saw on the school walk. He exaggerates a nose for a joke drawing. He is good at saying what a piece means.



The loft table

Print plates, sketchbooks, paints, soft wire and pliers live here. Clean as you go. Finished work dries on the side shelf.

You

Age about ten or eleven. Ready to combine techniques, finish independent projects, and talk about process as well as product.

How to use this book

✧ SIGNS TO LOOK FOR

- **Open the door** - talk before you begin
- **Warm up your hands** - a quick skill game
- **Your turn** - make, print, draw, paint or sculpt
- **Did you know?** - a true fact
- **Go a bit further** - extra challenge
- **Big challenge** - longer task
- **How did it go?** - short review

Dashed boxes are yours. Open making tasks have acceptance criteria in the Answers section, not right answers printed on the unit page.



Picture 0.1 Studio signs return on every page so you know what to do next.

Every topic runs in the same order

Once you have found your way through the first topic you know your way through all sixteen, because they are all built the same way.

IN THIS ORDER	WHAT YOU DO
Open the door	talk about the question before you make anything
Here is how it works	the teaching: read it, and try the small examples
Watch me work one out	Rufus or Bruno solves one in front of you
Your turn	you make, in the dashed boxes on the page
Go a bit further	an extension when you have finished, not more of the same
Check what you can do	three ticks, honestly

Each unit then closes with **How did it go?**, which reviews the whole unit rather than one topic.

How your work is judged

There is no mark out of ten for a print or a sculpture in this book. What is looked at is whether you did what the task asked, and whether you can explain your choices.

- **the making** is finished, and safe, and fits the task
- **the thinking** is written down: what you chose, and why
- **the evidence** is kept: tests, thumbnails and versions you rejected
- **the review** is honest, including the parts that did not work

The acceptance criteria for every task are printed in the **Answers** section at the back. You are allowed to read them before you start. Knowing what a good piece of work looks like is not cheating; it is how professionals work.

Getting set up

Your loft studio kit

- print: rollers, washable ink or paint, scrap card, foam stamps, string, leaves, scrapers
- drawing: H, HB, 2B pencils, rubber, sharpener, ruler, sketchbook
- painting: washable paints, flat and round brushes, palette, water pot, board or heavy paper
- wire: soft craft wire (adult-approved thickness), tape for ends, blunt pliers if allowed, card base
- apron or old shirt; newspaper for protection



Picture 0.2 Loft kit on the table: print tools, sketchbook, paints, soft wire and brushes.

Room norms

- 1 Look before you touch.
- 2 Share tools; return them.
- 3 Keep water, ink and paint contained.

- 4 Wire ends taped or capped; cutting tools only with adult rules.
- 5 Talk kindly about work: process, humour, story and form.

✦ WARM UP YOUR HANDS

Shake hands for five seconds. Press palms together, then open wide like stars. Three times. Ready.

Before you finish

The last ten minutes of a studio lesson decide whether the next one starts well.

- 1 Wet work goes flat on the side shelf to dry, with your name on it in pencil.
- 2 Brushes are washed, shaped to a point and stood **bristles up**, never resting on the bristles in a pot of water.
- 3 Rollers and plates are wiped before the ink dries; dried ink does not come off.
- 4 Wire offcuts go in the offcut tin, not the bin and not the floor.
- 5 The table is wiped and the newspaper is changed if it is wet through.

Losing a brush to a night spent standing on its bristles is the most common accident in a school studio, and it is entirely preventable.

UNIT 1 · PRINT TABLE

1

Combining printing approaches

Review methods, layer them, play with colour and pattern, then finish a print project.

A print is a mark transferred from one surface to another. Combining approaches means more than one method on the same sheet.

© IN THIS UNIT YOU WILL

- ✓ review and experiment with printing techniques you know
- ✓ combine different printing methods on purpose
- ✓ explore colour, texture and pattern in prints
- ✓ develop a final print project

◆ ON THE TABLE TODAY

Rufus rolls pale blue ink onto a foam stamp. Bruno lays string on a card plate.

"One pull is a mono-print," Rufus says. "Two methods on one page is a conversation."

Bruno grins. "I will stamp first and roll second. Order changes the story."



Picture 1.0 Step 1, lay the string plate. Step 2, roll the ink. Then pull.

A printer works backwards. You do not draw the picture; you build the **plate** that will make the picture, and the paper meets it once. That one moment is called the **pull**. Everything in this unit happens before the pull: choosing a method, inking it, deciding the order of layers, and testing until the pull is worth keeping.

Words at this table

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS HERE
plate	the surface you ink, before the paper meets it
pull	one press of paper onto the inked plate
relief print	a print from the raised parts of a plate
mono-print	a one-off print; each pull is unique
collagraph	a print from a plate built up with glued textures
registration	getting a second layer to land where you planned
edition	a set of prints from one plate, usually numbered

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.1

Reviewing and experimenting with previous printing techniques

Open the door

Which print method do you already trust with your hands: stamp, mono-print, or something else?

You have printed before. In earlier years you pressed sponges, carved soft blocks and rolled ink across a flat plate. This topic is a stocktake. You will make a small set of test pulls, label them, and find out which method your hands do best before you commit to a project.

► Here is how it works

METHOD	HOW IT WORKS	GOOD FOR
stamp / block	ink a raised shape; press onto paper	repeats, bold shapes
mono-print	paint or ink a plate; pull one unique print	soft marks, accidents you keep
collagraph idea	glue textures onto a plate; ink and press	rough texture patterns
found-object	ink a leaf, lace or card edge	natural or sharp edges

Every one of these is a **relief** idea: the parts that stand up take the ink and print, and the parts that sit low stay pale. Hold a plate to the light at a low angle before you ink it. If you cannot see which parts are raised, the print will not show it either.

Three words a printer uses

- the **plate** is the surface you ink
- the **pull** is the single press of paper onto plate
- an **edition** is a set of prints made from the same plate

✧ DID YOU KNOW?

A **relief print** uses the raised parts of the plate. What you carve away, or leave low, does not print.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Rufus wants to know whether his foam stamp prints better with thin ink or thick ink.

He does not guess. He cuts one stamp, then pulls it three times: once with a thin roll of ink, once with a normal roll, once loaded thickly. He writes *thin*, *normal* and *thick* under each pull in pencil.

The thick pull fills in the fine lines. The thin pull skips. He keeps the middle one and now knows how much ink his stamp wants.



Picture 1.1 Three small test prints side by side: stamp, mono-print and texture plate.

● YOUR TURN

Make three small test pulls, one per box. Use a different method in each. Label the method under each pull.

TEST A · METHOD:	TEST B · METHOD:
TEST C · METHOD:	NOTES: WHAT SURPRISED ME

My strongest method today:

Why I think so:

→ GO A BIT FURTHER

Take your weakest test and pull it again, changing **one** thing only: the amount of ink, the pressure, or the paper. Print the second pull beside the first so the change is easy to see.

FIRST PULL

SECOND PULL · WHAT I CHANGED:

Check what you can do

☐ I made three test pulls with three different methods.

- ☐ I labelled each pull with the method that made it.
 - ☐ I can say which method suits my hands, and why.
-

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.2

Combining different printing methods

■ Open the door

What happens if the second layer is darker than the first?

One method gives you one kind of mark. Two methods on one sheet give you a conversation: a soft mono-printed sky behind a crisp stamped bird, or a rough texture under a clean edge. The skill in this topic is not making more marks. It is deciding the **order**.

► Here is how it works

Combine on purpose:

- 1 Plan light layers first, darker layers later (or reverse if you want ghost marks).
- 2 Let each layer dry enough so it does not smear.
- 3 Align edges carefully, or misalign for energy.
- 4 Stop when the page still has breathing space.

Layer order is a decision you can explain. *Pale wash first, sharp shape second* puts the sharp shape in front. Swap them and the sharp shape sinks behind a veil. Neither is wrong; only one of them is what you meant.

Getting a layer back in the same place

Printers call this **registration**: making a second layer land where you planned. The simplest classroom method is a corner jig. Tape two strips of card at a

right angle on the table, push the paper into the corner for every pull, and each layer lands in the same place.



Picture 1.2a A corner jig of two taped card strips, with paper pushed into the corner before the pull.

◇ DID YOU KNOW?

Japanese woodblock printers carve a separate block for each colour, and cut the same registration marks, called **kento**, into every block: an L-shaped corner and a straight bar that the sheet is pushed against. A print with six colours has been printed six times, once from each block. Prints by Hokusai and Hiroshige often used between ten and twenty blocks.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Bruno stamps a pale circle, waits, then mono-prints thin blue lines across it.

Result: the circle stays the subject; the lines become weather.

He tries the reverse on a second sheet: lines first, circle on top. Now the circle reads as a moon in front of rain. Same two plates, same two

colours, different story, because the order changed.



Picture 1.2 One sheet with a pale stamp under a second mono-print layer.

● YOUR TURN

On one sheet, use **two** methods. Write the order you used, then say what the order did to the picture.

First method: _____ Second method: _____

COMBINED PRINT

The order put this in front:

→ GO A BIT FURTHER

Print the same two layers again in the **opposite** order on a smaller scrap. Peg the two versions side by side and ask a partner which one they read first.

ORDER A

ORDER B

My partner read this one first: _____

Check what you can do

- ☐ I used two different methods on one sheet.
- ☐ I can name the order I printed them in.
- ☐ I can explain what the order did to the picture.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.3**Exploring colour, texture, and pattern in prints****■ Open the door**

Is pattern only something that repeats, or can it also be a rhythm of textures?

► Here is how it works

IDEA	TRY THIS
colour	two related hues, or one warm and one cool
texture	string, fabric scrap, corrugated card
pattern	repeat a stamp; vary spacing
contrast	leave quiet white areas against busy ink

A pattern does not have to repeat exactly. Change the **spacing**, the **pressure** or the **angle** and the eye still reads a rhythm, the way a row of trees along a road is a pattern even though no two trees match.

Quiet areas do work

The busiest print in the room is rarely the best one. An area with no ink gives the eye somewhere to rest, and it makes the inked areas look stronger by comparison. Plan at least one quiet area before you start, and protect it.



Picture 1.3a A plate built up from card and cut shapes, lying beside the print it made. Compare the two: the raised parts carry the ink.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Rufus prints a strip of six leaf shapes. It looks like wallpaper: even, and a bit dull.

He prints a second strip and changes one thing at a time. Leaves one and two sit close. Three is turned. Four and five sit far apart. Six is pressed lightly so it almost disappears.

The second strip has the same six leaves and a rhythm. Nothing was added; the spacing did the work.

● YOUR TURN

Design a strip of three pattern experiments. Change spacing, angle or pressure between them, not the shape.

PATTERN STRIP 1-3

The texture that surprised me:

Where my quiet area is:



Picture 1.3 Pattern strip with stamp repeats and rough texture marks.

→ **GO A BIT FURTHER**

Print one strip using a warm colour and a cool colour together. Warm colours (reds, oranges, yellows) tend to come forward; cool colours (blues, greens, violets) tend to sit back. Put the warm mark on top of the cool one, then try it the other way.

WARM OVER COOL / COOL OVER WARM

Check what you can do

- ☐ I changed spacing, angle or pressure to make a rhythm.
 - ☐ I kept at least one quiet area on purpose.
 - ☐ I can name one warm and one cool colour in my print.
-

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.4

Developing a final print project

Open the door

What idea is worth finishing carefully as a final print?

This is the piece that goes in the studio show at the end of the book, so it is worth planning rather than starting straight away. Everything you tested in topics 1.1 to 1.3 is now evidence: you know your strongest method, you know what layer order does, and you know how to keep a quiet area.

► Here is how it works

A **final print project** needs:

- 1 a clear subject or mood
- 2 at least two methods combined
- 3 test pulls before the best pull
- 4 a short title and one sentence about process

Choosing a subject that prints well

Printing flattens things. A subject with a strong silhouette survives that; a subject that depends on tiny detail usually does not. A pine tree, a bicycle, a tram, a hand: all print well. Look for the shape you could still recognise as a shadow.

DO YOU REMEMBER?

In topic 1.2 you found that the second layer sits in front. Decide now which part of your final print you want in front, and print that part last.

WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Bruno wants to print the number 15 tram climbing a Lisbon street.

He tests the tram stamp on its own: too small, and the windows fill in. He cuts a bigger, simpler tram with three windows instead of eight.

Then he decides the order. Buildings are a pale mono-printed block, printed first so they sit back. The tram is stamped last, in a warm colour, so it comes forward. He pulls four tests before the one he keeps.

BIG CHALLENGE

Complete one finished print on good paper. Keep your best test pull as evidence of planning.

YOUR TURN

Title:

Methods used:

Why this order:

THUMBNAIL PLANS

FINAL PRINT SPACE / OR ATTACH PRINT

→ GO A BIT FURTHER

Print a small **edition**: three pulls of the same plate. Number them 1/3, 2/3 and 3/3 in pencil under the print, the way printers do. Then say which of the three is strongest and why, because they will not be identical.

Strongest pull, and why:

© HOW DID IT GO?

- ☐ I reviewed at least two printing techniques.
- ☐ I combined methods on one sheet.
- ☐ I explored colour, texture or pattern on purpose.
- ☐ I finished a final print project.

My best layering choice was:

Look at a maker: Katsushika Hokusai

Hokusai printed *The Great Wave off Kanagawa* in Japan in 1831. It is a colour woodblock print, and it was made the way you have been working in this unit: one block carved for each colour, inked and printed in a set order onto the same sheet.

Look at the blue. It is **Prussian blue**, a manufactured pigment from Europe that only reached Japanese printers in the 1820s. Hokusai used a new colour the moment it arrived, in a print that people still recognise two hundred years later.

Two things worth stealing from him:

- the wave is a **silhouette**. You could recognise it as a shadow, which is exactly

the test in topic 1.4 for a subject that prints well

- there is a mountain in the middle of the picture doing almost nothing, and it is

the quiet area that makes the wave loud

What I would steal from Hokusai:

Choosing your piece for the studio show

The print table sends one print and one test pull to the show at the end of the book. Decide now, while the work is in front of you.

Print I am sending:

Test pull I am sending with it, and what it shows about my planning:

UNIT 2 · DRAWING TABLE

2

Drawing humour and perspective

Vanishing points, exaggerated proportions, energy on the page, and depth you can feel.

Perspective builds depth. Humour builds character. Year 6 drawings can do both without losing control.

© IN THIS UNIT YOU WILL

- ✓ understand one- and two-point perspective
- ✓ explore exaggerated proportions for humour
- ✓ create dynamic and expressive drawings
- ✓ use perspective to create depth and space

◆ ON THE TABLE TODAY

Rufus draws a horizon line across the page. "Eye level first," he says.

Bruno draws a fox with huge shoes and a tiny hat. "Funny first," he says. "Then I will put the fox on a street that goes back in space."



Picture 2.0 Drawing table with ruler, pencils and a sketch showing a simple street in perspective.

These two ideas look like opposites. Perspective is measured and ruled; humour is loose and quick. A Year 6 drawing can hold both, and the last topic of this unit asks you to do exactly that: put a character with a joke in it inside a space that obeys the rules.

Words at this table

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS HERE
horizon line	your eye level in the picture
vanishing point	where parallel edges appear to meet on the horizon
one-point perspective	depth lines meet at a single vanishing point
two-point perspective	depth lines meet at two vanishing points
proportion	how the sizes of parts relate to each other
caricature	a portrait with one feature pushed further than life
line of action	the single curved line that carries a pose

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.1**Understanding one- and two-point perspective****■ Open the door**

If railway tracks seem to meet far away, how many vanishing points are you seeing?

Nothing in the world actually shrinks as it moves away from you. It only shrinks on your **retina**, and therefore on your paper. Perspective is the set of rules that copies that shrinking honestly onto a flat page.

► Here is how it works

Horizon line = your eye level on the page.

SYSTEM	VANISHING POINTS	USEFUL FOR
one-point	one	roads, halls, looking straight at a face of a box
two-point	two	corners of buildings, looking at an angle

Steps for a simple one-point box:

- 1 Draw the horizon.

- 2 Place one vanishing point (VP).
- 3 Draw the front rectangle.
- 4 Light construction lines from corners to the VP.
- 5 Close the back of the box; erase helper lines you do not need.

The horizon is your eye, not the ground

Move the horizon line up the page and the viewer feels tall, looking down on the scene. Move it down and the viewer feels small, looking up. The horizon is a decision about where the reader is standing, so make it on purpose.



Picture 2.1a Two studies of the same building: one-point on the left with a single vanishing point, two-point on the right with two, both on a ruled horizon.

✧ **DID YOU KNOW?**

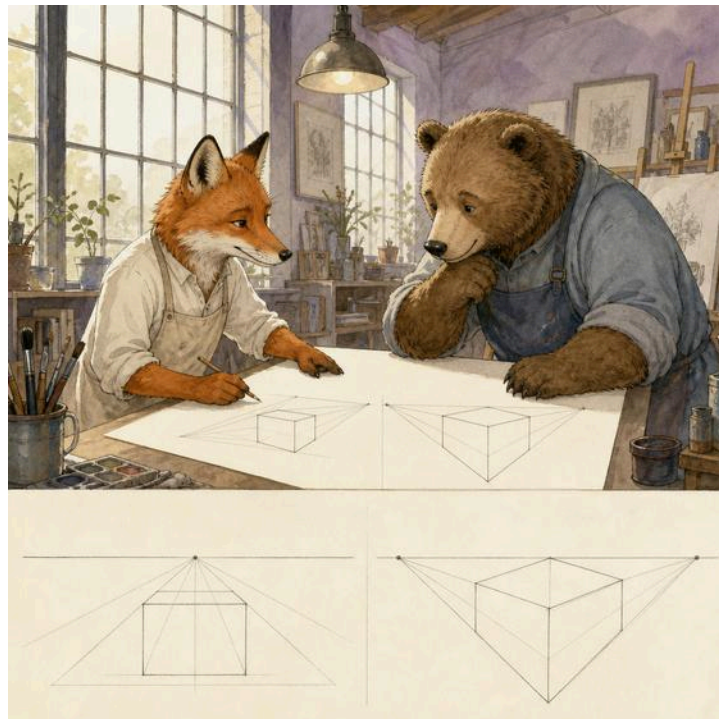
Linear perspective was worked out in Florence around 1415. The architect Filippo Brunelleschi painted the Baptistery on a small panel, drilled a peephole through it and held a mirror in front, so a viewer could compare his painting with the real building. Within a lifetime it had changed how European painters drew.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Rufus draws a corridor in one-point perspective.

He rules the horizon two thirds up the page, marks the vanishing point slightly left of centre, and draws the far doorway as a small rectangle around it. Then he takes four faint lines from the corners of that rectangle out towards the edges of the paper.

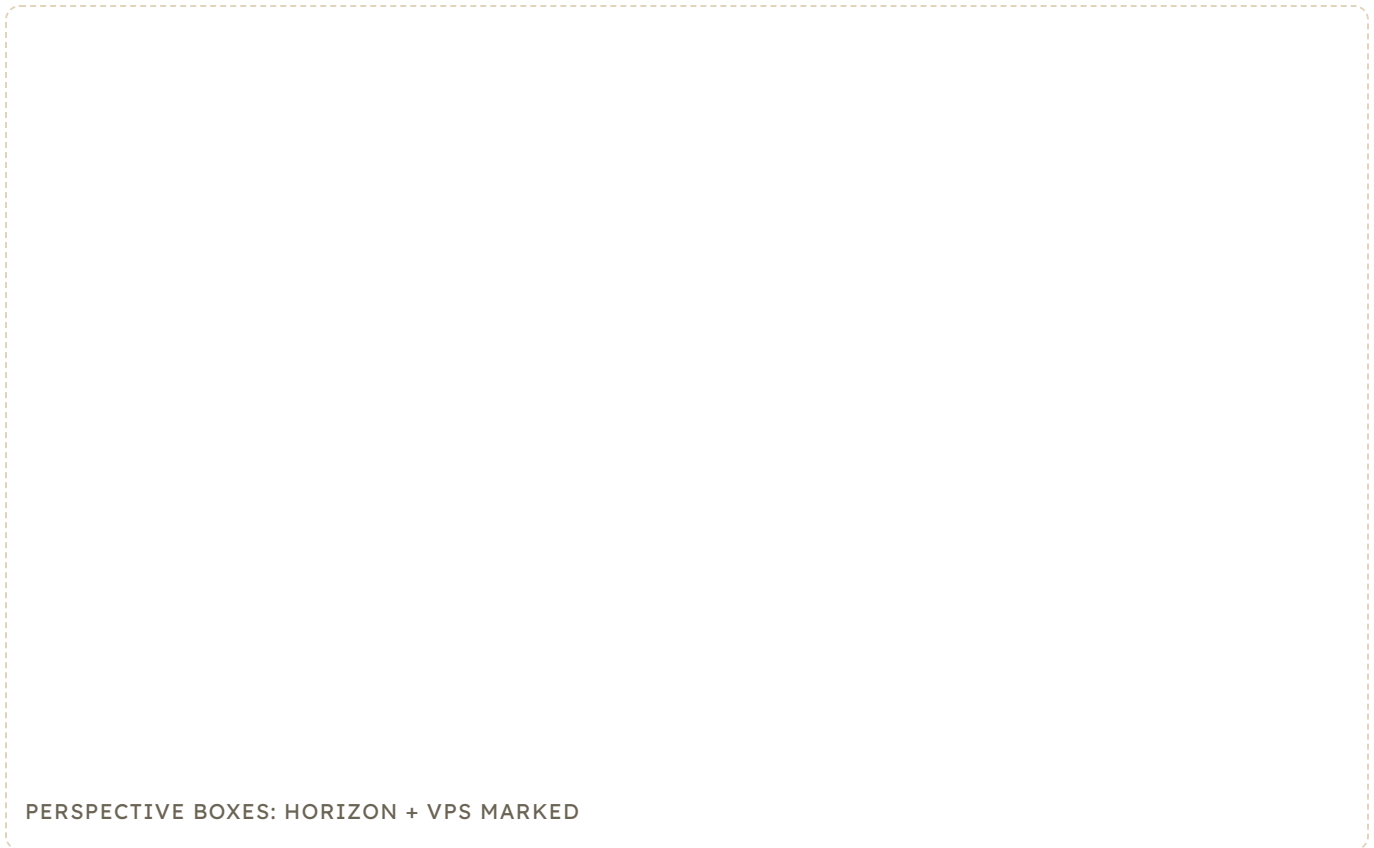
Everything in the corridor now sits between those four lines: the floor tiles, the tops of the doors, the row of lamps. He draws the near lamp large, the far lamp small, and both of them lean towards the same point.



Picture 2.1 One-point and two-point boxes drawn lightly with horizon and vanishing points.

● YOUR TURN

Draw one one-point box and one two-point box. Rule the horizon first and mark your vanishing points with a small cross before you draw anything else.



Where I put the horizon, and why:

→ GO A BIT FURTHER

Draw the same box three times with the horizon in three different places: above the box, through the box and below it. Write under each one whether the viewer feels tall, level or small.

HORIZON HIGH

HORIZON THROUGH

HORIZON LOW

WHAT THE VIEWER FEELS

Check what you can do

- ☐ I ruled a horizon line and marked my vanishing points.
- ☐ I drew a box in one-point perspective.
- ☐ I drew a box in two-point perspective.
- ☐ I can say what moving the horizon does to the viewer.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.2**Exploring exaggerated proportions and humour in drawing****■ Open the door**

Can a drawing be funny without being mean?

► Here is how it works

Exaggeration changes size relationships on purpose: huge feet, long nose, tiny eyes, tall hat.

Rules for kind humour in class:

- laugh with characters, not at real people in the room
- keep the pose readable
- one big exaggeration is clearer than five small ones

Find the feature first

A caricature is not a bad drawing of a face. It is an accurate drawing of the **one thing** that makes a face itself, pushed further than life. Look for the feature you would mention if you had to describe someone down a telephone, then make that feature carry the joke while everything else stays calm.

◇ DID YOU KNOW?

The word **caricature** comes from the Italian *caricare*, meaning to load or to exaggerate. A caricature is a portrait carrying more of something than the real face does.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Bruno draws Rufus three times.

The first drawing is honest: a fox with a long muzzle and neat ears. The second lengthens the muzzle by half and leaves everything else alone. The third stretches the muzzle until it is nearly as long as the body, shrinks the ears, and lifts one eyebrow.

Drawing three is the funniest and still clearly Rufus, because only one thing was pushed. When Bruno tried pushing the ears, the eyes and the tail as well, the fox stopped being anyone at all.



Picture 2.2a Bruno works up three studies of the same face on one board while Rufus poses for him.

● YOUR TURN

Redraw the same simple character twice: normal proportions, then humorous exaggeration.

NORMAL

EXAGGERATED

What I exaggerated: _____



Picture 2.2 Side-by-side character: balanced proportions and a humorous exaggerated version.

→ GO A BIT FURTHER

Swap books with a partner. Draw a kind caricature of a **character they invented**, not of your partner. Push one feature only, then let them tell you which feature you chose. If they guess it straight away, the drawing worked.

PARTNER'S CHARACTER, ONE FEATURE PUSHED

Check what you can do

- ☐ I drew the same character in normal and exaggerated proportions.
- ☐ I pushed one feature rather than five.

☐ My drawing is funny and still kind.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.3

Creating dynamic and expressive drawings

■ Open the door

What makes a figure look as if it is mid-jump rather than standing still?

► Here is how it works

Dynamic drawings use:

- diagonal lines and action lines
- weight on one foot or a lean
- faces with clear emotion (brows, mouth shape)
- less stiff symmetry

The line of action

Before you draw a figure, draw the single curved line that runs from the head to the foot carrying the weight. That is the **line of action**. Build the body around it and the pose will hold together; draw the head, then the arms, then the legs separately and the figure usually goes stiff.

✦ WARM UP YOUR HANDS

Thirty seconds: draw five tiny stick figures each doing a different action. No erasing.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Rufus draws a figure kicking a ball.

First a single curved line, leaning back at the shoulders and forward at the kicking foot. He checks it looks like a movement on its own, before there is any body on it.

Then the head at the top, the ribcage and hips as two simple boxes turned against each other, and the arms thrown out to balance the kick. The drawing takes two minutes and looks faster than a careful one that took ten.

● YOUR TURN

Draw one expressive figure in motion. Draw the line of action first, lightly, and leave it visible.

DYNAMIC FIGURE · LINE OF ACTION LEFT IN

Emotion shown: _____



Picture 2.3 Expressive figure mid-stride with light action lines.

→ GO A BIT FURTHER

Draw the same figure twice: once with the weight evenly on both feet, once with all the weight on one foot. Only the second one will look alive. Write one sentence saying why.

WEIGHT ON BOTH FEET

WEIGHT ON ONE FOOT

Why the second looks alive:

Check what you can do

☐ I drew a line of action before the body.

- ☐ My figure leans or carries its weight on one side.
- ☐ A viewer can name the emotion without being told.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.4

Using perspective to create depth and space

■ Open the door

How can you make a funny character feel as if it is standing on a real street?

► Here is how it works

Combine skills:

- 1 Establish horizon and vanishing point(s).
- 2 Build a simple space (street, room, stage).
- 3 Place your humorous character so feet sit on the ground plane.
- 4 Make distant objects smaller; nearer objects larger.

Where the feet go

This is the join that usually fails. A character floats when the feet are drawn at a height that does not agree with the ground. Find where the ground plane is at that distance, put the feet **on** it, and the character lands in the street instead of hovering above it.

🕒 DO YOU REMEMBER?

In topic 2.1 the horizon was your eye level. If a character's eyes are on the horizon line, they are exactly as tall as you and standing on your ground, however far away they are.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Bruno puts his long-nosed fox on a Lisbon street.

He rules the horizon, sets one vanishing point at the end of the road, and draws the buildings on both sides leaning to it. Then he draws the fox near the front, large, with both feet on the pavement line.

For a second, smaller fox further up the street he checks the eye line: the far fox's eyes sit on the same horizon, so the two foxes are the same height, one just happens to be forty metres away.

▲ BIG CHALLENGE

Finish a full scene: humorous character + clear depth (one- or two-point).

● YOUR TURN

Title of scene:

Perspective type: _____

DEPTH + HUMOUR SCENE

The trick that made the depth work:

→ GO A BIT FURTHER

Add one more character much further down the street. Keep their eyes on the horizon line and draw them small. If they still look like a child rather than a distant adult, check the eye line again.

FAR CHARACTER ON THE SAME HORIZON

© HOW DID IT GO?

- ☐ I can explain one- and two-point perspective.
- ☐ I exaggerated proportions for humour.
- ☐ I drew a dynamic, expressive figure.
- ☐ I used perspective to create depth and space.

My clearest depth trick was:

Look at a maker: Honore Daumier

Daumier drew caricatures for French newspapers in the 1830s. In December 1831 he published a drawing of the king, Louis-Philippe, as a giant swallowing baskets of money. He was tried in February 1832, fined 500 francs and sent to prison for six months. From 1835 he drew for *Le Charivari*, almost daily, for years.

His exaggerations are small. He usually pushed **one** thing, the shape of a head or the length of a back, and left the rest accurate, which is the rule in topic 2.2 and the reason his drawings still read today.

A drawing also put him in prison, so caricature is clearly powerful. That is why this book asks you to invent characters to laugh at rather than draw real people in the room.

One feature Daumier would push on my character:

Choosing your piece for the studio show

The drawing table sends one piece to the show at the end of the book. Decide now, while the work is in front of you, rather than in a hurry on the last day.

Piece I am sending:

What a viewer should notice first:

Why this one and not another:

UNIT 3 · PAINT TABLE

3

Painting creatively from encounters

Observe what you really meet, then paint with choice, texture and story.

An encounter is something you meet with your eyes: an object, a person, a plant, a weather mood. Paint from that meeting, not only from imagination.

© IN THIS UNIT YOU WILL

- ✓ observe and interpret objects, people or nature
- ✓ experiment with colour, texture and brush techniques
- ✓ develop a personal painting from observation
- ✓ use paint for visual storytelling

◆ ON THE TABLE TODAY

Bruno places an olive branch in a jar. "I met this on the windowsill," he says. "I will paint what I see, then what it feels like."

Rufus squeezes three colours. "Interpretation is not inventing a different plant. It is choosing which truth to emphasise."



Picture 3.0 Paint table with palette, brushes and a simple still-life encounter ready to paint.

Everything in this unit starts with something real in front of you. That is the difference between Year 6 painting and painting from memory: you have a subject that can argue back. When your painting and the thing disagree, you look again.

Words at this table

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS HERE
observation	looking carefully at something real while you make
block-in	the first large areas of colour, before any detail
wash	thin paint laid in an even pass
dry brush	little water, so the bristles drag and skip
warm colours	reds, oranges and yellows, which tend to come forward
cool colours	blues, cool greens and violets, which tend to sit back
en plein air	painting outdoors, in front of the subject

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.1**Observing and interpreting objects, people, or nature****■ Open the door**

What is the difference between copying every detail and interpreting what you see?

► Here is how it works

Observe: look for big shapes, light and dark, colour temperature.

Interpret: keep the subject recognisable, but choose emphasis (edge, colour, mood).

Loop: look, paint a little, look again, adjust.

Big shapes before small ones

Squint at your subject until the detail disappears and only three or four large shapes remain. Those shapes are the painting. If they are right, a viewer will recognise the subject from across the room, and every detail you add afterwards will land in the right place. If they are wrong, no amount of detail rescues it.

◇ DID YOU KNOW?

Painting outdoors in front of the subject has a French name that painters still use: *en plein air*, meaning in the open air. Painters had worked outdoors for a long time already, but it became far easier after 1841, when the collapsible metal paint tube was patented and colour could finally be carried about without drying out.



Picture 3.1a The fox and the bear painting outdoors from a real view, boards on their knees.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Rufus paints the olive branch in the jar.

He squints first. Four shapes: the pale jar, the dark mass of leaves, the shadow on the table, the bright window behind. He lays those four in with a big brush and no detail at all, and stops to check from two metres away.

Only then does he paint single leaves, and he paints six of them, not sixty. The rest stay as the dark mass, which is what your eye sees anyway.

● YOUR TURN

Choose one real encounter. Sketch the big shapes first, then a quick colour note beside it.

Subject I met:

Where and when I met it:

BIG SHAPES ONLY, SQUINT FIRST

COLOUR NOTES



Picture 3.1 Still-life encounter beside a painted interpretation that keeps the big shapes true.

→ GO A BIT FURTHER

Paint the same encounter a second time in three minutes flat, with the largest brush you have. Compare the two. The fast one is often truer, because there was no time to fuss.

THREE-MINUTE VERSION

Check what you can do

- ☐ I worked from something real, not from memory.
- ☐ I found the big shapes before any detail.
- ☐ My painting is recognisable from across the room.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.2

Experimenting with colour, texture, and brush techniques**■ Open the door**

Which brush mark feels calm: a long flat wash or short dry-brush scratches?

► Here is how it works

TECHNIQUE	HOW	MOOD IT CAN GIVE
wash	thin paint, even pass	soft sky, calm base
dry brush	little water, dragged bristles	rough bark, energy
dab / stipple	tip of brush dots	leaves, texture
scrape	edge of card or brush handle	sharp light lines

The brush mark is not decoration added at the end. It carries mood on its own: the same grey painted as a smooth wash reads as mist, and painted as dry scratches reads as smoke.

Mixing without mud

Two colours make a clean mix. Three usually make a duller one. Four almost always make brown. If a mix has gone muddy, do not add more colours to fix it: wash the brush, mix a fresh pair, and put the clean colour beside the dull one so the dull one looks deliberate.

✧ DID YOU KNOW?

Warm colours (reds, oranges, yellows) often advance. Cool colours (blues, cool greens) often recede. Use that for depth without perspective lines.



Picture 3.2a A painted strip of warm colours beside a strip of cool ones, with palette, water pot and round brush.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Bruno paints a hillside with pine trees.

For the far hill he mixes blue with a little of the green, keeps it thin, and lays a flat wash. For the near pines he uses the same green with almost no water and drags the bristles so the paper texture shows through.

Two marks, one colour family. The far hill sits back and the near trees come forward, and he has not drawn a single perspective line.

● YOUR TURN

Paint a five-box technique strip and label each box.



TECHNIQUE STRIP: WASH / DRY BRUSH / DAB / SCRAPE / YOUR OWN

My favourite for texture: _____

Where I would use it:



Picture 3.2 Palette mixes beside a brush-technique test strip.

→ **GO A BIT FURTHER**

Paint one small square using only two colours plus white. Mixing is limited, so the work has to be done by the marks. Write down which two colours you allowed yourself.

Two colours used: _____

TWO-COLOUR SQUARE

Check what you can do

- ☐ I made at least four different brush marks and labelled them.

- ☐ I can name a warm colour and a cool colour in my own work.
- ☐ I mixed with two colours rather than four.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.3

Developing a personal painting from observation

Open the door

Which encounter matters enough that you will finish a full painting of it?

► Here is how it works

A **personal painting from observation** needs:

- 1 a real subject you can see (or a clear photo only if the teacher allows for access)
- 2 colour choices written down
- 3 a base wash or block-in before details
- 4 a short title

What makes it personal

Two pupils can paint the same jar and hand in two different paintings, honestly. Personal does not mean inventing something that is not there. It means choosing what to emphasise: the light rather than the object, the pattern rather than the shape, the cold of the morning rather than the colour of the leaves.

DO YOU REMEMBER?

In topic 3.1 you squinted to find the big shapes. Do it once more before you start this painting, because a finished piece is where the temptation to begin with detail is strongest.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Rufus paints the studio window at 08:30, when the light is low and cold. His colour note says three words: *pale, grey-blue, one warm*. He blocks the whole board in grey-blue, including the window frame, and lets it dry. Then he adds the single warm mark: the copper handle catching the sun. It takes ten seconds and it is the reason the painting works. His title is *Half past eight*.

▲ BIG CHALLENGE

Finish one personal painting from a real encounter. Write the title and one sentence about what you chose to emphasise.

● YOUR TURN

Title:

Colours I chose:

What I emphasised:

PERSONAL PAINTING SPACE / OR ATTACH PAINTING

→ **GO A BIT FURTHER**

Write a two-line label for your painting as if it were hanging in a gallery: the title, and one sentence telling a stranger what to look at first.

Look at this first:

Check what you can do

- ☐ I blocked in before I added detail.

- ☐ I wrote my colour choices down before painting.
- ☐ My painting has a title and one thing I chose to emphasise.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.4

Visual storytelling

■ Open the door

Can three small paintings tell a story without any words?

► Here is how it works

Visual storytelling sequences images:

- beginning, middle, end
- or calm, change, calm again
- or same place at three times of day

Keep characters or objects consistent so the viewer can follow.

What has to stay the same

A sequence only reads as one story if something survives all three panels. Usually that is the place, the light, or one object. If the colour family, the brush marks and the subject all change between panels, a viewer sees three paintings rather than one story.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Bruno paints the same windowsill three times: morning, afternoon, evening.

The jar does not move and the framing does not change. Only the light does: cold grey-blue, then warm yellow, then deep violet with one lit edge.

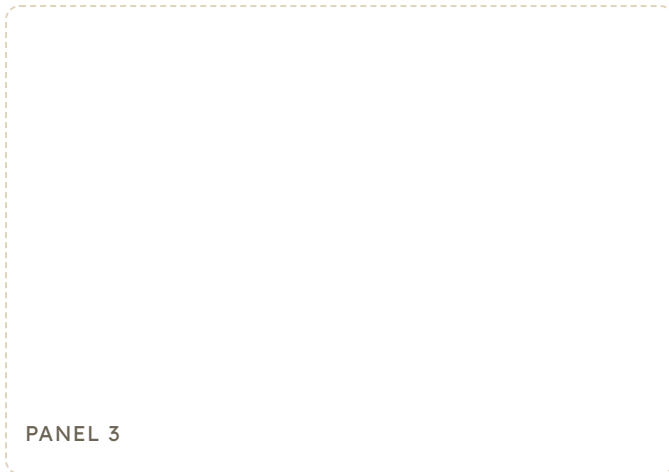
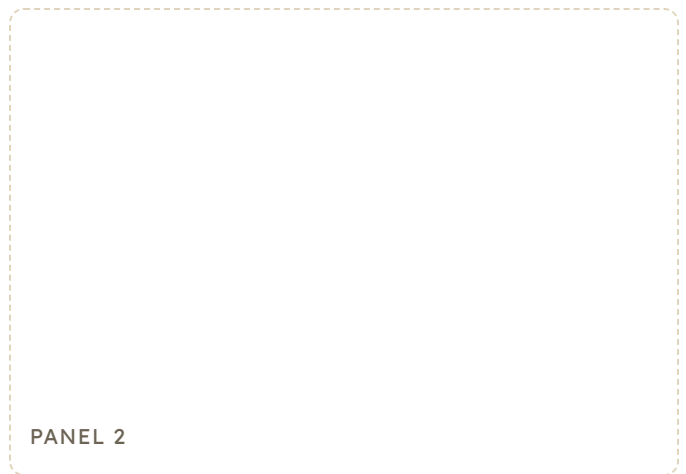
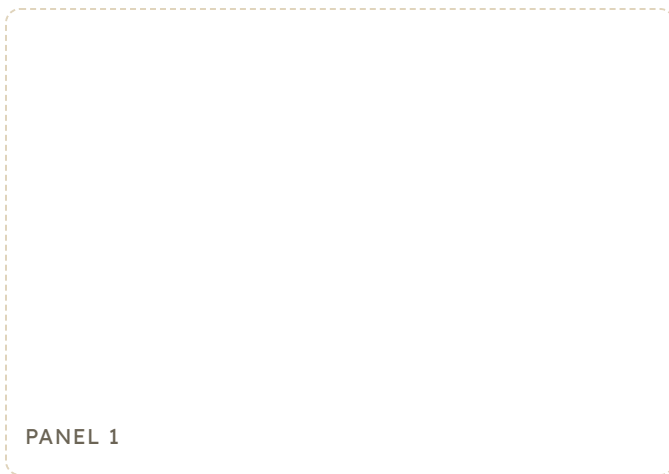
Nothing happens in the pictures, and it is still a story, because the viewer supplies the day that passed between them.

● YOUR TURN

Plan a three-panel painted story from real encounters (or one encounter changing).



Picture 3.3 Three small painted panels that show a simple visual story.



Story in one sentence:

What stays the same in all three panels:

→ GO A BIT FURTHER

Show your three panels to a partner in the wrong order and ask them to put them right. If they can, the sequence is working.

My partner put them in this order: _____

© HOW DID IT GO?

- ☐ I observed and interpreted a real encounter.
- ☐ I tried colour, texture and brush techniques.
- ☐ I developed a personal painting from observation.
- ☐ I made a visual story in paint.

The choice that made my work more personal:

Look at a maker: Josefa de Obidos

Josefa de Obidos was born in Seville in 1630 and grew up in Obidos, an hour north of Lisbon, in the town she is named after. Her father was a painter and she learned in his workshop. She never married, ran her own studio, and about 150 paintings are attributed to her. She died in Obidos on 22 July 1684 and was buried there.

She is best known for **still lifes**: sweets, cheeses, flowers and fruit on a plain table, painted from observation. They are worth looking at while you work on this unit, because they do exactly what topic 3.1 asks.

- the objects are ordinary, and she does not pretend otherwise
- the light comes from one side and she keeps it there
- most of the picture is quiet and dark, so a handful of pale objects carry it

You can see her work in Portuguese museums. If you are near Obidos, you are in the town she painted in.

The most ordinary object I could paint well:

Choosing your piece for the studio show

The paint table sends either the personal painting or the three story panels. Decide now, while both are in front of you.

Piece I am sending:

The choice I made in it that I want noticed:

Why this one and not the other:

UNIT 4 · WIRE TABLE

4

Sculpting with wire

Line becomes form: bend, texture, mixed materials, and a sculpture that stands in space.

Wire is drawing in three dimensions. It holds air as well as metal. Safety and structure matter as much as style.

© IN THIS UNIT YOU WILL

- ✓ understand wire as a sculptural material
- ✓ experiment with texture and effects
- ✓ combine wire with other materials
- ✓ build three-dimensional forms that stand

◆ ON THE TABLE TODAY

Rufus tapes the ends of a soft craft wire. "No sharp goodbyes," he says.

Bruno bends a simple figure armature. "If the feet are wide, the wire person can stand while I add detail."



Picture 4.0 Wire table with soft craft wire, tape, card base and a simple armature in progress.

This is the only unit in the book where your work has a back. A print and a drawing are finished when the front is right. A sculpture is finished when you have walked round it, so every task here asks you to turn the piece and look again.

Words at this table

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS HERE
armature	an inner support that helps a sculpture stand
free-standing	stands on its own base and can be walked around
structure	the parts that carry weight: legs, frames, cages
texture	how a surface seems to feel, made here by spacing
mixed materials	anything added to the wire, each doing one job

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.1**Understanding wire as a sculptural material****■ Open the door**

Is wire more like a pencil line or more like a bone under a body?

It is both, and which one it is depends on the job you give it. Left visible, a wire is a line drawn in the air. Buried inside paper or fabric, the same wire becomes the skeleton that holds a shape up.

► Here is how it works

Wire can be:

- **line** in space (open drawings you can walk around with your eyes)
- **armature** (inner support for other materials)
- **structure** (legs, frames, cages)

Safety first:

- use soft craft wire approved by your teacher
- tape or cap cut ends
- pliers only with permission
- no wire near eyes; wash hands after work

Why sculptors start with the armature

An armature carries the weight so the surface does not have to. Build the wire skeleton first, check it stands on its own with nothing on it, and only then add paper, fabric or tape. A form built the other way round collapses as soon as it is loaded, and it always collapses when it is nearly finished.



Picture 4.1a A part-finished form on a wooden base, with the wire armature still visible inside the shape, beside pliers, tape and a coil of soft wire.

❖ DID YOU KNOW?

Wire sculpture became widely known through the American artist Alexander Calder. After he moved to Paris in 1926 he drew portraits in wire, and between 1926 and 1931 he built *Cirque Calder*, a miniature circus of figures made from wire, fabric and wood, which he performed himself in front of an audience.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Bruno makes a wire bird.

He starts with one continuous length and bends the body outline in the air, without cutting: head, back, tail, under the belly, back to the head. One wire, one closed shape.

Then he adds a second, shorter wire for the legs and twists it round the belly, and he splays the feet wide before he lets go. The bird stands, and there is nothing on it yet.

● YOUR TURN

Bend three pure-wire experiments: a spiral, a simple figure outline, a geometric frame.

SPIRAL

FIGURE OUTLINE

FRAME

NOTES: WHICH STOOD UP ON ITS OWN

Where all my cut ends are:



Picture 4.1 Three small wire experiments: spiral, figure outline and geometric frame.

→ GO A BIT FURTHER

Make one shape from a **single unbroken wire**, with no cuts and no joins at all. It is harder than it sounds, and it teaches your hands to plan the route before they bend.

ONE WIRE, NO CUTS

Check what you can do

- ☐ I made three wire experiments and secured every cut end.
- ☐ I can say which of mine is a line, which is an armature and which is a structure.

- ☐ One of my pieces stands on its own.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.2

Experimenting with texture and effects

■ Open the door

How can one continuous wire look soft in one place and sharp in another?

► Here is how it works

EFFECT	HOW
coil / spring	wrap wire tightly around a pencil (adult help if needed)
mesh feel	cross wires and twist joins lightly
dense shadow	pack loops closer together
open air	leave large empty shapes

Density is your tone

In a drawing you make an area darker by pressing harder. In wire you make it darker by packing the loops closer, because a dense tangle stops the light and an open loop lets it through. A wire sculpture has lights and darks exactly as a drawing does, and you control them with spacing.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Rufus makes a texture sample of a hedgehog's back.

He tries three ideas on one card. Wide loops look like nothing much. Loops packed at about a finger's width look like fur. Loops packed so tightly they touch look like a solid lump and lose the prickles.

The middle one wins, and he writes the spacing on the card so he can repeat it.

● YOUR TURN

Make one texture sample board: three different wire textures fixed to card.

TEXTURE SAMPLES: COIL / MESH / DENSE

The densest texture I made: _____

Which one stops the most light: _____



Picture 4.2 Card sample with three wire texture effects side by side.

→ GO A BIT FURTHER

Hold your sample board up against a window and look at the shadow it throws on the table. The shadow is the tone. Sketch the shadow rather than the wire.

THE SHADOW, NOT THE WIRE

Check what you can do

- ☐ I made three clearly different wire textures.
- ☐ I can explain how spacing changes how dark a texture looks.

- ☐ I fixed my samples safely to card.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.3

Combining wire with other materials to add detail and texture

■ Open the door

What material would make wire look like a bird has feathers, without hiding the wire structure?

► Here is how it works

Combine carefully:

ADD-ON	USE SPARINGLY FOR
tissue / tissue paper	soft colour skins
fabric scrap	flags, cloaks, leaves
foil	reflective accents
beads (large, supervised)	joints or eyes
card	bases and wings

Join with twist, tape or school-safe glue as allowed. Keep the wire readable.

One material, one job

Decide what each added material is **for** before you add it. Tissue for softness, foil for a highlight, card for a base. When a piece has four materials all doing the same job, it stops looking designed and starts looking like whatever was on the table.

■ WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Bruno builds a wire fish. He adds one tissue paper fin and stops.

Result: the wire still draws the body; the tissue only accents movement.

He had cut three fins. Adding the second and third made the fish look wrapped rather than built, so the other two went back in the box.

● YOUR TURN

Build a small mixed-material wire piece. List the materials and what each one is for.

Materials:

What each one is for:

WIRE + MATERIALS



Picture 4.3 Wire form with a little fabric or tissue added for detail.

→ GO A BIT FURTHER

Take one material **off** your piece and look again. If it is better without it, leave it off. Knowing when to stop is a skill you can practise.

What I removed, and whether it improved:

Check what you can do

- ☐ I combined wire with at least one other material.
- ☐ The wire structure is still readable.
- ☐ I can say what job each material is doing.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.4

Building three-dimensional forms

■ Open the door

Does your sculpture look interesting from the back as well as the front?

► Here is how it works

A successful 3D wire form:

- 1 has a stable base or wide feet
- 2 has height, width and depth (not a flat drawing on a stand)
- 3 can be viewed from more than one angle
- 4 has a clear subject or abstract idea

The flat sculpture trap

The commonest fault in wire work is a piece that is really a drawing standing up: it looks right from the front and disappears from the side. Test for it early.

Turn the piece ninety degrees and ask whether there is anything to see. If the answer is no, bend some of the wire towards you before you go any further.



Picture 4.4a One wire form set up as three studies side by side, so the same shape can be compared from different directions.

DO YOU REMEMBER?

In topic 4.1 the armature had to stand on its own with nothing on it. Check that again now, because a final piece carries more weight than a test did.

WATCH ME WORK ONE OUT

Rufus builds a standing figure with an arm raised.

From the front it reads immediately. From the side it is a flat line, so he pulls the raised arm forward and pushes the far leg back, and turns the head a little.

Nothing was added and the figure now occupies space from every side. He tapes the feet to a small wooden base so it cannot tip while he works on it.

▲ BIG CHALLENGE

Finish a free-standing wire sculpture. Photograph or sketch three views: front, side, back.

● YOUR TURN

Title:

What the form is about:

FINAL WIRE FORM / ATTACH PHOTO OF SCULPTURE

Three-view notes: front _____ side _____ back _____

→ GO A BIT FURTHER

Draw your own sculpture from the side, from observation, using the line of action you practised in unit 2. Drawing your own piece is the fastest way to find out what it actually looks like.

MY SCULPTURE, DRAWN FROM THE SIDE

© HOW DID IT GO?

- ☐ I treated wire as a sculptural material with safety.
- ☐ I experimented with texture and effects.
- ☐ I combined wire with other materials carefully.
- ☐ I built a three-dimensional form that stands.

The view that works best: _____

Look at a maker: Alexander Calder

Calder moved to Paris in 1926 and began drawing with wire instead of a pencil. His wire portraits are single continuous lines bent in the air: no shading, no surface, just an outline that happens to be standing up. Hold one to a wall and its shadow is a drawing.

Between 1926 and 1931 he built *Cirque Calder*, a miniature circus of small figures made from wire, fabric and wood, with acrobats, a lion tamer and a trapeze. He was not only the maker. He performed it himself, moving the figures by hand in front of an audience, and the performances made his name in Paris.

What that is worth to you in this unit:

- **a line is enough.** He did not fill anything in, and the figures still read
- **wire can be funny.** The circus is a joke told in metal
- **it moved.** Yours does not have to stand still either, if the base allows it

If my wire form could move one part, it would be:

Choosing your piece for the studio show

The wire table sends the free-standing sculpture. It is the only piece in the show that needs a table rather than a wall, so it also needs a decision about which way it faces.

The view I want facing the room:

What a viewer should notice first:

Whether it is safe to be picked up, and why:

Studio show

Choose one finished piece from each unit (or your strongest four pieces) and present them as a mini loft show.

UNIT	EVIDENCE TO SHOW
1 Print	final combined print + one test pull
2 Drawing	depth + humour scene
3 Painting	personal observation painting or story panels
4 Wire	free-standing wire form (photo or real piece)

For each piece, write:

- title

- materials / methods
- one sentence: what I want viewers to notice
- one sentence: what I would change next time

Writing a label a stranger can use

A gallery label does not explain the whole piece. It gives a visitor one thing to look at, and then gets out of the way. Keep it to two lines and put the interesting word first.

LABEL 1 · PRINT	LABEL 2 · DRAWING
LABEL 3 · PAINTING	LABEL 4 · WIRE

Hanging the show

- put the four pieces at the eye level of the people who will look at them, not at yours
- leave a hand's width of empty wall between pieces so each one can be seen on its own
- the wire piece needs a table, not a wall, and room to be walked around
- check the labels are all the same way up and the same distance below the work

One thing I would do differently if I hung it again:

Answers

Open studio tasks do not have a single correct picture. Use these **acceptance criteria**.

Unit 1 - Printing

TOPIC	ACCEPT IF THE PUPIL...
1.1	produced three labelled test pulls using different methods
1.2	combined two methods on one sheet and named the order
1.3	showed colour/texture/pattern choices with at least one quiet area
1.4	finished a final print with title and process note

Go a bit further: 1.1 the second pull changes exactly one variable, named in writing; 1.2 the two orders are printed and a partner's first reading is recorded; 1.3 warm and cool are both present and the pupil can say which came forward; 1.4 three pulls numbered 1/3, 2/3, 3/3 with a reason for the strongest.

Unit 2 - Drawing

TOPIC	ACCEPT IF THE PUPIL...
2.1	drew clear one-point and two-point boxes with horizon/VP
2.2	showed kind humour via deliberate exaggeration
2.3	drew a figure with readable motion or emotion
2.4	placed a character in a space with believable depth

Go a bit further: 2.1 three horizons with the viewer's feeling named for each; 2.2 a partner can identify the pushed feature unprompted; 2.3 both weight versions drawn and the difference explained; 2.4 the far character's eyes sit on the same horizon line.

Unit 3 - Painting

TOPIC	ACCEPT IF THE PUPIL...
3.1	worked from a real encounter and kept big shapes true
3.2	labelled a technique strip with distinct brush effects
3.3	finished a personal observation painting with a title
3.4	sequenced three panels that a viewer can follow

Go a bit further: 3.1 a three-minute version exists beside the slow one; 3.2 a two-colour square with the two colours named; 3.3 a two-line gallery label; 3.4 a partner reorders the panels correctly.

Unit 4 - Wire

TOPIC	ACCEPT IF THE PUPIL...
4.1	made three safe wire experiments with ends secured
4.2	produced three distinct wire textures on a sample
4.3	combined wire with at least one other material without hiding structure
4.4	built a free-standing 3D form and considered more than one view

Go a bit further: 4.1 one shape from a single uncut wire; 4.2 the shadow drawn rather than the wire; 4.3 one material removed and the effect judged; 4.4 the pupil's own sculpture drawn from the side.

Closed check (these have right answers)

QUESTION	ANSWER
How many vanishing points in one-point perspective?	one, on the horizon
How many in two-point perspective?	two, both on the same horizon
What is the horizon line?	your eye level in the picture
Which colours tend to come forward?	warm ones: reds, oranges, yellows
Which parts of a relief plate print?	the raised parts
What is a pull?	one press of paper onto the inked plate
What does an armature do?	it carries the weight so the surface does not have to
Near and far: which is drawn larger?	near

Studio words

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS
armature	an inner support that helps a sculpture stand
block-in	the first large areas of colour, laid before any detail
caricature	a portrait with one feature deliberately pushed further than life
collagraph	a print from a plate built up with glued textures
cool colours	blues, cool greens and violets, which tend to sit back
depth	the sense of near and far on a flat surface
dry brush	little water on the brush, so the bristles drag and skip
edition	a set of prints pulled from the same plate, usually numbered
en plein air	painting outdoors, in front of the subject
free-standing	a sculpture that stands on its own base and can be walked around
horizon line	the eye-level line where sky meets ground in a drawing
kento	the registration marks cut into a Japanese woodblock so each colour lands in place
line of action	the single curved line through a figure that carries the pose
mono-print	a one-off print; each pull is unique
one-point perspective	depth lines meet at a single vanishing point
plate	the surface a printer inks, before the paper meets it
proportion	how the sizes of parts relate to each other
pull	one press of paper onto an inked plate
registration	getting a second layer to land exactly where you planned
relief print	a print from the raised parts of a plate or block

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS
texture	how a surface seems to feel, or how materials show that
two-point perspective	depth lines meet at two vanishing points
vanishing point	the point on the horizon where parallel edges appear to meet
visual storytelling	using images to show a sequence, mood or idea
warm colours	reds, oranges and yellows, which tend to come forward
wash	thin paint laid in an even pass
wire sculpture	three-dimensional form built mainly from wire

Sources and references

Everything printed in a *Did you know?* panel in this book was checked before it went on the page. These are the sources used.

FACT	WHERE IT WAS CHECKED
Japanese woodblock: one block per colour, kento registration marks, ten to twenty blocks for Hokusai and Hiroshige	British Museum; Encyclopedia of Woodblock Printmaking; JAPAN HOUSE Los Angeles
Brunelleschi's perspective demonstration in Florence, around 1415, with a painted panel, a peephole and a mirror	Smarthistory; Khan Academy
<i>Caricature</i> from the Italian <i>caricare</i> , to load or exaggerate	Etymonline; Britannica; Tate
<i>En plein air</i> , and the collapsible metal paint tube patented in 1841	Smithsonian Archives of American Art; Linda Hall Library
Alexander Calder in Paris from 1926; <i>Cirque Calder</i> built 1926 to 1931 from wire, fabric and wood	Calder Foundation; Whitney Museum of American Art

The scheme of work in PDF/Input was used for scope and sequence only. Every sentence in this book is original.

For teachers

Mapping

Four units match the school scheme file Y6 Art & Design - Student Book.xlsx (Combining Printing Approaches; Drawing Humour and Perspective; Painting Creatively from Encounters; Sculpting with Wire). Assessment and school activities rows in the scheme are supported by Studio show and the notes below.

Assessment (studio show)

UNIT	EVIDENCE
1	final combined print project
2	humorous figure in perspective space
3	observation painting and/or visual story
4	free-standing wire sculpture

The shape of a topic

Every topic in this book runs in the same order, so pupils know where they are: *Open the door* (talk), *Here is how it works* (teach), *Watch me work one out* (model), *Your turn* (make), *Go a bit further* (extend), and *Check what you can do* (a short self-review). The end of each unit closes with *How did it go?*

The *Go a bit further* tasks are genuine extensions rather than more of the same, and they are the natural place to stretch a confident pupil without moving them off the topic the rest of the class is on.

Differentiation

- pupils who find the making hard: accept the *Your turn* box alone; the extension is optional

- pupils who finish early: the *Go a bit further* box, then a second version of the same task with one constraint changed
- pupils who struggle to write: the write-on lines may be answered aloud and scribed

School activities

- Print market: display final prints in the corridor with process notes
- Perspective street: collaborative large paper with shared horizon
- Encounter walk: short outdoor/indoor observation before painting
- Wire garden: safe table display of free-standing forms

Safety

Print inks/paints: washable where possible; protect tables. Wire: soft craft wire only; tape ends; pliers and cutters adult-controlled. Follow school policy for all tools.

Studio sketchbook

These pages are yours to work in whenever you finish early, or when a lesson leaves you with an idea you do not want to lose. Each one has a prompt, because a blank page with no instruction is the hardest page in any book to start.

Dates are worth writing in. A sketchbook you can put in order is evidence of how you changed across the year.

Five minutes: the thing nearest your left hand

Draw it without lifting the pencil off the paper. Look at the object more than at the page.

DATE:

Ten minutes: the same object, three times

Once in outline only. Once in tone only, no outline at all. Once in five marks or fewer.

OUTLINE ONLY

TONE ONLY

FIVE MARKS

WHICH ONE IS MOST LIKE IT, AND WHY

A corner of this room, in perspective

Find the horizon first. It is at the height of your own eyes, wherever you are sitting.

DATE:

Someone's hands while they work

Hands are hard, which is the reason to draw them. Draw the shape of the space between the fingers rather than the fingers themselves.

DATE:

A pattern you found, not one you invented

Copy a repeat you actually saw: tiles, a railing, brickwork, a jumper, a pavement. Write where you found it.

Found at:

DATE:

Free page

No prompt. Use it for whatever the year left you wanting to make.

DATE:

My studio notes

Ideas, colour mixes that worked, a method you want to remember, a piece you want to make next year.

NOTES

NOTES

PRIME BOOKS

Art & Design

Year 6 · Cambridge Primary · Student Manual

Welcome to the Loft Studio.

The last studio of primary school, and the most independent. Twenty topics across four units, a portfolio that is yours alone, and an exhibition to finish.

INSIDE THIS BOOK

- Twenty topics across four units
- The most independent making yet
- A modelled making in every topic
- A portfolio that is yours alone
- An exhibition of your own to finish

Prime Books · Art & Design

Ages 10–11 · Upper Primary

primeschool.pt